



Good, Bad and the Unsaid

DELHI The BJP national executive meet slated for the end of June could add to the rising mercury in the capital. It's a mixed agenda facing BJP President Rajnath Singh. Uncomfortable topics like the party's electoral debacles in Uttar Pradesh and Goa are certain to be discussed. However, the president's men hope that these will be offset by recalling some good news—the election wins in Uttarakhand and Punjab.

But seasoned party

watchers tend to believe that in the true tradition of the BJP, fireworks will be put on hold and matters are more likely to be brushed under the carpet as leaders ready themselves for the next round of elections.

Better still, party leaders who want to avoid responsibility for the successive defeats should perhaps adopt Gujarat dissident leader Keshubhai Patel's formula. At the recent Patel convention in Gujarat, organised

TAKING STOCK: Rajnath purely as a show of strength by his supporters against Chief Minister Narendra Modi, the dissident leader was missing.

Well, at least the BJP is willing to introspect its loss, unlike the Congress, which is yet to discuss its poor show in the Hindi heartland. The official line, as stated by both Sonia Gandhi and heir apparent Rahul, has clearly blamed the state organisation for the party's lacklustre performance. No one has questioned Rahul's handling of the election campaign in spite of the fact that the Congress had fielded him as its mascot and left the entire campaign to him. In fact, at a Congress Working Committee meeting, the party even discussed the Gurjar uprising in BJP-ruled Rajasthan but Uttar Pradesh never figured.

After all, it's so much easier to discuss someone else's problems. In the Congress, some things never change.

by Priya Sahgal

Eternal Vigilance

CHANDIGARH Having unleashed the Vigilance Bureau against former chief minister Amarinder Singh, his family and acolytes, the Shiromani Akali Dal-BJP Government is in an overdrive to get Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal, his wife Surinder Kaur and son, MP Sukhbir Singh, off the 'vigilance' hook in the corruption case slapped



COVER-UP: Badal

against them during the previous Congress regime. The state prosecution department, which had put up a challan against the Badals leading to framing of charges against them in March, has now developed cold feet. The administration has also removed seven special public prosecutors who had prepared and followed the chargesheet against the Badals.

Even more galling is a volte face by vigilance officials with regard to the department's assessment reports that gave Badal and his family a clean chit in the disproportionate assets case. Before the SAD-BJP combine came to power, the department had dismissed the bureau reports as "irrelevant". But soon after the change of guard, the state investigating agency has changed its stance, accepting the same reports as the grounds for further probes. by Ramesh Vinayak

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